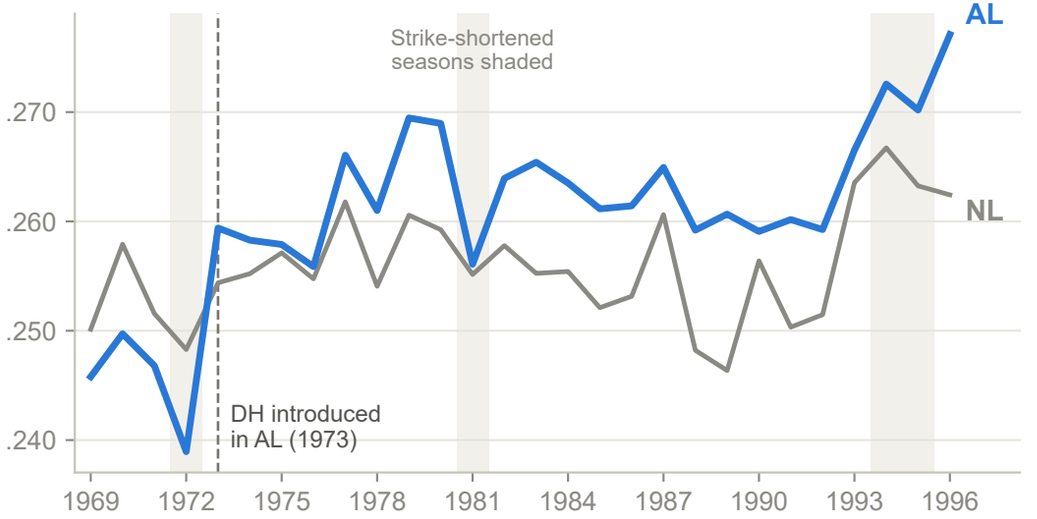
After the DH arrived in 1973, AL hitters out-hit the NL every season through 1996

Yearly league averages, American League (AL, blue) vs. National League (NL, gray), 1969–1996.
AL batting average trailed the NL in all four seasons before 1973 and led in all 24 after.

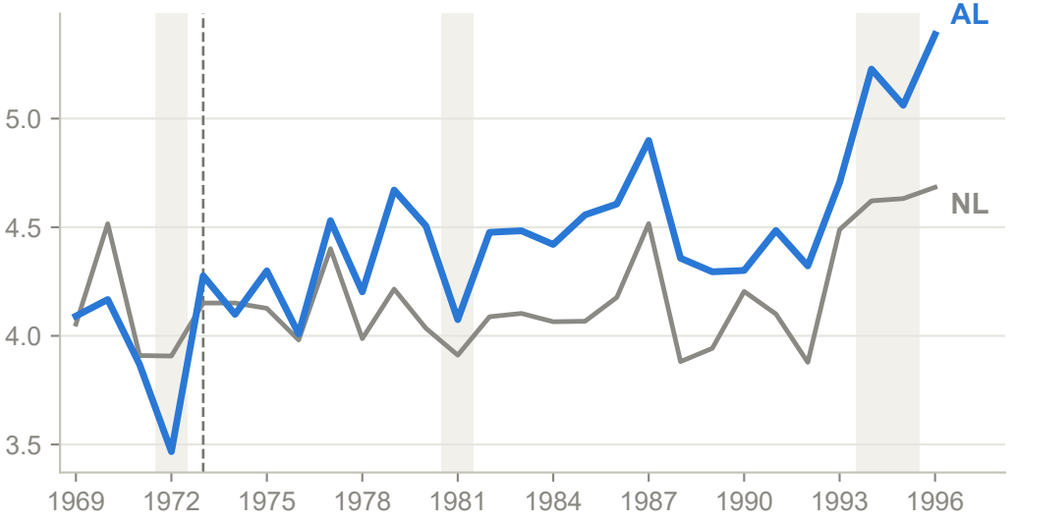
Batting average

Hits per at-bat, league average



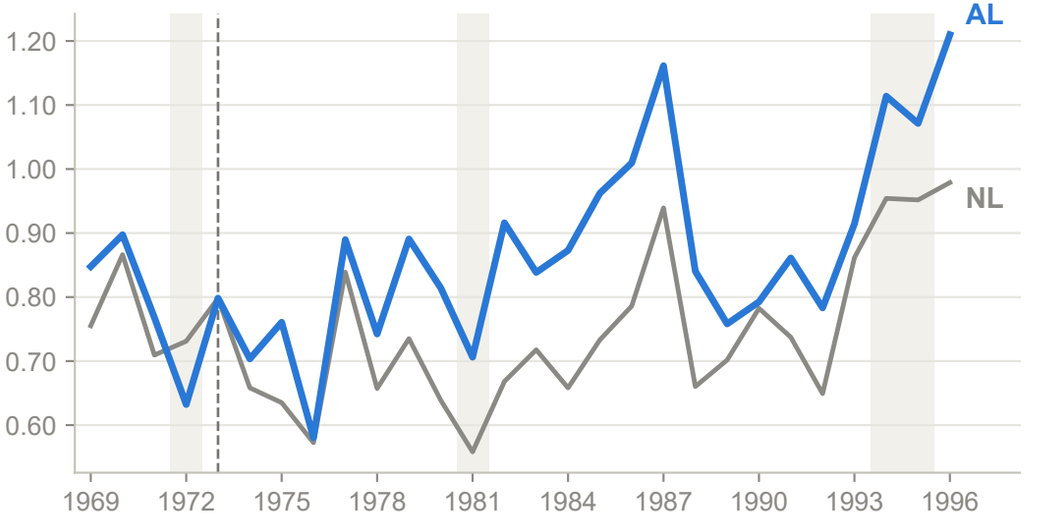
Runs per game

Runs scored per team per game



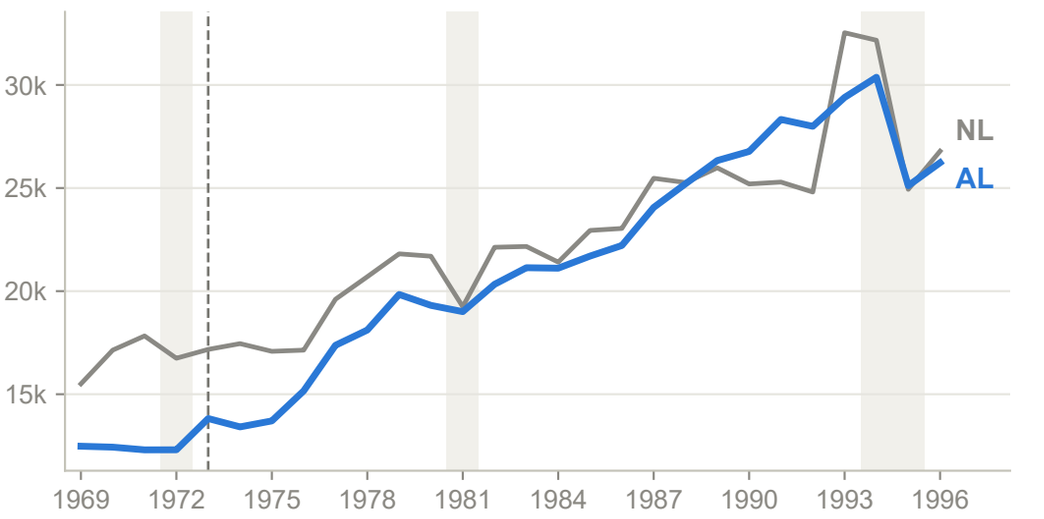
Home runs per game

Home runs hit per team per game



Attendance per home game

Average fans per home game, in thousands



Source: SABR Lahman Baseball Database (2025). Notes: Averages are across teams in each league (12 per league in 1969–76; the AL grew to 14 teams in 1977 and the NL in 1993). Shaded seasons (1972, 1981, 1994–95) were shortened by player strikes; all measures are per game or per at-bat, so shorter seasons remain comparable. The project's estimates use 1969–1976 only; later years are shown for context and also reflect expansion and other changes.